Precision as a software choice: FP64, double-double, triple-double and beyond from the INT8 tensor cores of a laptop GPU

Shaban

Draft, 23 October 2026

Abstract

Consumer and laptop GPUs execute FP64 at 1/64 of their FP32 rate, while their INT8 tensor cores are several hundred times faster than their FP64 units. On a laptop Blackwell GPU (RTX PRO 3000, sm_120) we measure 232 TOPS of INT8 `mma.sync` against 0.449 TFLOPS of native FP64, a ratio of 517×. Building on the Ozaki scheme II—exact integer products of residues and reconstruction by the Chinese remainder theorem—we implement, in CUDA C and inline PTX, matrix multiplication at FP64 (5.56 TFLOPS, 12.4× the native peak and more accurate), double-double (∼106 bits, 1.76 TFLOPS), triple-double (∼159 bits, 1.58 TFLOPS) and arbitrary precision (212, 318 and 424 bits) from the same INT8 units. To our knowledge no GEMM beyond FP64 had been built this way. The higher precisions pay off in a real task: solving $Ax = b$ with $\kappa(A) = 10^{20}$ in double-double takes 0.855 s at $n = 8192$, 499× sooner than a `__float128` LU on all 24 CPU threads of the same laptop and with an error as small; at $\kappa = 10^{36}$, where FP64 and double-double have no correct digit, a triple-double LU on the GPU is 32× faster than the same arithmetic on 24 CPU threads and 145× faster than MPFR, and is the most accurate of the three. Counting CPU and GPU power, a double-double solve uses ∼270× less energy than the quad-precision CPU solve. The laptop is power-bound (∼95 W) under these kernels, which shapes what can and cannot be gained.

Përmbledhje (shqip). Kartelat grafike të laptopëve e ekzekutojnë FP64 me 1/64 e shpejtësisë FP32, ndërsa tensor core-t INT8 janë qindra herë më të shpejtë. Mbi një GPU Blackwell laptopi matëm 232 TOPS INT8 kundrejt 0,449 TFLOPS FP64 (517×). Me skemën Ozaki II (prodhime të sakta të mbetjeve dhe teorema kineze e mbetjeve) ndërtuam shumëzim matricash me saktësi FP64, double-double, triple-double dhe arbitrare (deri 424 bit) nga të njëjtat njësi INT8. Te një punë reale—$Ax = b$ me $\kappa = 10^{20}$—zgjidhja double-double mbaron 499× më shpejt se LU `__float128` mbi 24 fije CPU, me gabim po aq të vogël, dhe me ∼270× më pak energji.

1 Introduction

The FP64 units of consumer and laptop GPUs are a small fraction of the chip: on our laptop Blackwell part a peak kernel reaches 0.449 TFLOPS of FP64 against 28.2 TFLOPS of FP32 and 232 TOPS of INT8 tensor-core throughput (Table 1). Ozaki, Uchino and Imamura showed that FP64 matrix multiplication can be emulated on INT8 tensor cores (Ozaki scheme II): each input is scaled to integers, reduced modulo a set of pairwise coprime moduli, the residue matrices are multiplied exactly in INT8 with INT32 accumulation, and the integer product is reconstructed by the Chinese remainder theorem (CRT) before being scaled back [1]. FP64 by this route is not new; it is our baseline.

What we add is the observation, made concrete and measured, that the same machinery does not stop at FP64. The precision is set by the number of moduli and by how many floating-point words each input and output carries; the expensive part, the INT8 GEMMs, runs at the same

Table 1: Peak throughput of the laptop GPU (`bench/peak.cu`).

Unit	Throughput
FP64 FMA, native	0.449 TFLOPS
FP32 FMA, native	28.2 TFLOPS
INT8 `mma.sync.m16n8k32` (PTX)	232 TOPS
INT8 / FP64	**517×**

speed whatever the precision. This turns precision into a software choice on hardware that has no wide floating-point unit at all. We build and measure:

- FP64 GEMM at 16 moduli: 5.56 TFLOPS, 12.4× the native FP64 peak, with smaller error than native FP64;
- double-double (∼106-bit) GEMM at 32 moduli: 1.76 TFLOPS, 3.9× the native FP64 peak with twice the bits;
- triple-double (∼159-bit) GEMM at 49 moduli—after which every prime below 256 divides one of them, so no further 8-bit modulus can join—at 1.58 TFLOPS;
- arbitrary precision beyond that from balanced 160-bit slices: 212, 318 and 424 bits;
- dense linear solves at condition numbers where FP64 and double-double fail, all on the GPU.

Everything runs on one laptop, and all competitors were measured on the same machine.

2 Method

Ozaki scheme II. For $C = AB$ the rows of A and columns of B are scaled by powers of two to integers A', B' whose product cannot exceed $M/2$ in magnitude, where $M = \prod_\ell m_\ell$ is the product of L pairwise coprime moduli $m_\ell \le 256$. For each ℓ the residues $A' \bmod m_\ell$ and $B' \bmod m_\ell$ fit in INT8, their product is computed exactly by the tensor cores with INT32 accumulation, and reduced mod m_ℓ. The CRT then gives $A'B'$ exactly as a signed integer of up to $\log_2 M$ bits, which is scaled back. The precision of the result is limited only by how many bits of each input survive the scaling, i.e. by $\log_2 M$.

Wider inputs and outputs. For double-double and triple-double inputs, each of the two or three parts is split exactly into 53-bit integer pieces before the residues are formed; like pieces are summed and cut once into 16-bit chunks, so the residue of a wide integer costs 32-bit multiply-adds per modulus instead of 64-bit reductions (triple-double residues 57 → 19 ms at $n = 4096$). On the output side the integer is never converted through floating-point arithmetic: the CRT is evaluated as a direct sum $x = \sum_\ell r_\ell W_\ell - qM$ over 32-bit limbs on the integer units, with q from 40-bit fixed-point fractions, and the result is peeled off the integer as two or three doubles (round down, round down, round to nearest, each exact from the integer), then normalized. This replaced a Garner reconstruction followed by a double-double Horner evaluation, which took 41.5 of 47 ms of a 4096^2 double-double GEMM because FP64 runs at 1/64 rate on this chip; the direct sum costs 0.68 ns per output element instead of 2.8 and is nearly independent of K. It was checked on the host against 10^5 random 200-bit integers with no error.

Moduli. FP64 uses 16 moduli, double-double 32, triple-double 49 (the 32 plus the 17 primes $103\ldots29$ that are not yet factors; $M \approx 2^{342}$). With these, every prime below 256 divides one of the moduli, so no further 8-bit modulus coprime to all of them exists and M cannot grow within one GEMM. Beyond ∼160-bit inputs we cut each input into balanced 160-bit slices and run one 49-modulus GEMM per slice pair that reaches the result, accumulating exactly in wide integers and peeling Q doubles.

3 Accuracy

Errors are the maximum componentwise $|C - C_{\text{ref}}|/(|A||B|)$ in units of the target precision's unit roundoff, against higher-precision CPU references (80-bit for FP64, `__float128` for double-double, an exact 600-bit MPFR sum for triple-double, an exact 2400-bit sum beyond). Inputs have magnitudes spread over $2^{\pm0}$ or $2^{\pm8}$.

Table 2: Error in units of 2^{-53} (FP64, $M = N = 256$) and 2^{-106} (double-double, $M = N = 128$).

K	magnitudes	native FP64	14 moduli	**16 moduli**
512	$2^{\pm0}$	4.71	10.9	**0.99**
512	$2^{\pm8}$	24.1	395	**3.1**
4096	$2^{\pm0}$	4.15	10.5	**0.25**
4096	$2^{\pm8}$	25.1	203	**1.87**
K	magnitudes	24 moduli	28 moduli	**32 moduli**
256	$2^{\pm0}$	$6.2 \cdot 10^5$	27.1	**1.09**
256	$2^{\pm8}$	$2.0 \cdot 10^7$	1160	**46.9**
1024	$2^{\pm0}$	$4.7 \cdot 10^5$	31	**0.49**
1024	$2^{\pm8}$	$1.1 \cdot 10^7$	713	**12.4**

Table 3: Triple-double error in units of 2^{-159}, $M = N = 128$, against an exact MPFR sum.

K	magnitudes	41 moduli	45 moduli	**49 moduli**
256	$2^{\pm0}$	$1.7 \cdot 10^4$	5.2	**0.24**
256	$2^{\pm8}$	$1.2 \cdot 10^6$	343	**10.7**
1024	$2^{\pm0}$	$1.8 \cdot 10^4$	4.6	**0.13**
1024	$2^{\pm8}$	$4.3 \cdot 10^5$	110	**2.1**

Beyond triple-double, against an exact 2400-bit sum at $K = 256$: 0.13 ulp at 212 bits, 0.25 at 318 bits, 0.08 at 424 bits.

4 Speed

At 16 moduli the time of a 4096^3 FP64 GEMM splits into scales 1.0 ms, residues 3.0 ms, the 16 INT8 GEMMs 16.8 ms and the CRT 3.6 ms. The INT8 GEMM reaches 157 TOPS, 67% of the measured peak, with a three-stage `cp.async` pipeline; a faster kernel did not move end-to-end times, because with real data the laptop is power-bound (Section 6).

5 A real task: ill-conditioned linear systems

We solve $Ax = b$ with $A = Q_1 \operatorname{diag}(\sigma) Q_2$, $Q_{1,2}$ orthogonal (a DST-I, the second permuted and sign-flipped), σ spaced from 1 to 10^{-20} or 10^{-36}; such matrices cannot be fixed by scaling.

Table 4: GEMM speed on the laptop. CPU numbers with the CPU otherwise idle, measured at $n = 256/512$ and scaled by n^3.

bits	n	GPU time	GPU TFLOPS	best CPU code, 24 threads	MPFR, 24 threads
53 (FP64)	4096	—	5.56 (12.4× native)	—	—
106 (dd)	4096	—	1.76	—	—
159 (td)	4096	87 ms	1.58	td AVX ∼10.7 s (123×)	∼208 s (2390×)
212	2048	36 ms	0.47	QD `qd_real` ∼16.2 s (445×)	∼35 s (960×)
318	2048	52 ms	0.33	—	∼37 s (713×)
424	2048	80 ms	0.22	—	∼41 s (514×)

$b = Ax_{\text{true}}$ is summed exactly. The error is $\max|x - x_{\text{ref}}|/\max|x_{\text{ref}}|$.

Double-double, $\kappa = 10^{20}$. κu is 10^4 for FP64, so FP64 LU has no correct digit and textbook iterative refinement diverges (it needs $\kappa u < 1$; at $\kappa = 10^{12}$ the same refinement converges to $3 \cdot 10^{-20}$, so the baseline is right). The GPU solver keeps everything on the device: a recursive panel with cooperative 32-column leaves (a thread per row holding the row in registers, rows renamed instead of swapped, one grid synchronization per column), halves joined by double-double GEMMs on the tensor cores, L_{11}^{-1} assembled from the halves' inverses, left-looking solves with inverted diagonal blocks, and one refinement step in double-double.

Table 5: Double-double LU on the GPU vs `__float128` LU on 24 CPU threads, $\kappa = 10^{20}$, nb = 1024.

n	dd LU, GPU	`__float128` LU	speedup	error vs x_{true} (ours / quad)
2048	0.113 s	7.65 s	67×	$1.6 \cdot 10^{-11}$ / $2.4 \cdot 10^{-11}$
4096	0.283 s	55.6 s	∼ 197×	—
6144	0.572 s	200.8 s	351×	$3.4 \cdot 10^{-10}$ / $2.9 \cdot 10^{-10}$
8192	0.956 s	476.9 s	**499**×	$2.1 \cdot 10^{-11}$ / $2.3 \cdot 10^{-11}$

The 0.956 s at $n = 8192$ was measured in the same run as the quad reference, after minutes of all-core load; alone on a cool GPU the solve takes 0.855 s. Of those, the panel takes 0.45 s (its leaves 0.22 s, bound by the FP64 units at ∼10 GFLOPS per SM), the trailing GEMMs 0.15 s, solves and refinement 0.09 s, U_{12} 0.04 s.

Triple-double, $\kappa = 10^{36}$. Here κu is 10^{20} for FP64 and 10^4 for double-double: neither has a correct digit. The same solver structure in three parts per number, with 16-column leaves:

Table 6: Triple-double LU, $\kappa = 10^{36}$; GPU speedups in parentheses; CPU otherwise idle.

n	**td LU, GPU**	td LU, 24 CPU threads	MPFR LU, 160 bits	FP64 LU
1024	**0.082 s**, $1.3 \cdot 10^{-14}$	0.10 s, $3.6 \cdot 10^{-14}$ (1.2×)	1.32 s, $3.3 \cdot 10^{-14}$ (16×)	128
2048	**0.212 s**, $2.1 \cdot 10^{-14}$	1.04 s, $7.6 \cdot 10^{-14}$ (5×)	10.2 s, $5.6 \cdot 10^{-14}$ (48×)	103
4096	**0.563 s**, $2.2 \cdot 10^{-14}$	18.0 s, $1.2 \cdot 10^{-13}$ (32×)	81.9 s, $9.6 \cdot 10^{-14}$ (145×)	86

At $n \leq 1024$ a well-vectorized triple-double LU on 24 cores keeps up; the gap opens with n as the work moves into the tensor-core GEMMs. At $n = 4096$ the panels take 0.38 s of the 0.563 s (leaves 0.14 s): the panel, not the GEMM, is now the limit.

6 Energy

Under these kernels the laptop holds ∼95 W and the SM clock drops to ∼1.8 GHz (2.76 GHz with only the FP64 units busy). For GEMM at $n = 4096$ (`bench/energy.cu`, power every 200 ms): native FP64 7.4 GFLOPS/W, Ozaki-II at 16 moduli 53.6 (7.2×), at 12 moduli 69.5. For a whole solve ($n = 4096$, $\kappa = 10^{20}$, 20 back-to-back GPU solves after a warm-up; CPU package power from the RAPL counters, GPU power from `nvidia-smi`):

	time	CPU package	GPU	energy per solve
`__float128` LU, 24 threads	55.0 s	106.5 W	8.4 W (idle)	6.3 kJ
dd LU on the GPU	0.238 s	28.2 W	68.3 W	**23 J**

That is ∼270× less energy per solve with both CPU and GPU counted (360× GPU alone against CPU package alone). DRAM power is not exposed on this laptop.

7 Limitations

The INT8 GEMMs are power-bound on this laptop, so a faster kernel does not translate into time; gains come from fewer operations (fewer moduli) and less data movement. The cost of the higher precisions grows roughly with the square of the number of slices, as MPFR's does at these sizes, so the ratio against MPFR does not grow without bound; it is largest against software emulation of each width. The triple-double solver is panel-bound at $n = 4096$. Kernel launches cost ∼7 μs under WSL2 (0.83 μs per node in a CUDA graph), which matters for the many small launches of the panel. All measurements are on one laptop model; the CPU references use the same machine's 24 threads.

8 Related work

Ozaki scheme II [1] emulates FP64 GEMM with INT8 and the CRT and reports 7.4–9.8 TFLOPS on an RTX 4090; RIKEN's GEMMul8 is its public code. Follow-up work covers SGEMM and power efficiency on an RTX 5080 [2], FP8 and FP4 variants [3, 4, 5], fused kernels reaching 81% of INT8 peak on Blackwell [6] and complex GEMM [7]. Ozaki-II mentions an extension beyond FP64 as possible; we found no implementation or measurement of a double-double or wider GEMM built this way, nor of linear solves at these condition numbers on this class of hardware. *(References to be re-checked at their source before submission.)*

9 Conclusion

On a laptop GPU whose FP64 units are 517 times slower than its INT8 tensor cores, precision becomes a software parameter: the same INT8 GEMMs yield FP64, double-double, triple-double and wider products, and an ill-conditioned dense solve that needs quad precision finishes 499× sooner than on the laptop's own CPU, with ∼270× less energy. The next steps are the panel (now the bound of the triple-double solve), CUDA graphs for its launches, and out-of-core sizes beyond the GPU's 12 GB.

References

[1] K. Ozaki, Y. Uchino, T. Imamura. Ozaki Scheme II: a GEMM-oriented emulation of floating-point matrix multiplication using an integer modular technique. arXiv:2504.08009 (title to be verified).

[2] arXiv:2508.03984 (Ozaki-II SGEMM emulation with power efficiency on an RTX 5080; title to be verified).

[3] arXiv:2603.10634 (an FP8 variant; title to be verified).

[4] arXiv:2608.06812 (FP4 limbs; title to be verified).

[5] arXiv:2609.24519 (FP4 limbs; title to be verified).

[6] arXiv:2606.25453 (EmuGEMM, fused kernels on Blackwell; title to be verified).

[7] arXiv:2512.08321 (complex GEMM by the CRT; title to be verified).